

Chapter 68 Part 6

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One of Xu Qingzhu's bracelets had been left behind at the cemetery.

The car had already driven several hundred meters away when Xu Qingzhu discovered it, so Liang Shi drove back to accompany her to retrieve it.

Then they saw a woman in a black trench coat holding an umbrella, sheltering herself and a child underneath it. The two were crouched in front of Sheng Qinglin's grave.

They were too far away, and with the rain falling, they couldn't hear what was being said at all.

But Xu Qingzhu stood there with a wooden expression.

Through the silhouettes, Liang Shi roughly guessed who this was.

It was Su Yao and Su Yu.

But she didn't proactively tell Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu didn't ask either. She just calmly watched this scene.

"Should we... go over and take a look?" Liang Shi asked tentatively.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, her voice very soft. "No need."

She didn't say anything, but her eyes were very complex.

Liang Shi knew she would need time to digest this matter.

After a long while, Xu Qingzhu moved her somewhat stiff body, as if giving herself enough courage. But as she was about to walk over, she asked Liang Shi, "Someone who might be my aunt has appeared. It's okay for me to go over and ask, right?"

Liang Shi reached out and grasped her hand.

Xu Qingzhu's hand was originally cold, but now it was even colder, like an ice block.

Liang Shi's hand wrapped around hers as she firmly nodded at her. "Of course you can. I'm still right here beside you. Teacher Xu, let's go."

As she spoke, she was about to pull her over, but Xu Qingzhu couldn't move her feet.

Xu Qingzhu's hand was trembling. Although she was tightly gripping Liang Shi's hand, she pulled back. "But she has a new child. Should I really disturb their peaceful life?"

Liang Shi comforted her. "Why would you? You're just going to ask, or just meet them."

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, her feet stepping backward. She smiled bitterly. "Forget it. She might just be my uncle's friend."

Xu Qingzhu let out a light breath, trying to calm her thoughts as much as possible. "Let's go, let's go home."

But Liang Shi looked at her. "Teacher Xu, you were speaking so confidently just now? How did you become a coward now? We're just going to look. Besides, I've met that little child before. We're just saying hello, it's not some big deal."

Xu Qingzhu looked up at her, her eyes watery, asking in a trembling voice, "Is it that Sheng Yu?"

Liang Shi nodded. "She's Rainbow's classmate. I'm going to greet a classmate's parent."

Xu Qingzhu still shook her head. She closed her eyes. "Liang Shi, don't."

Liang Shi looked at her, seeming to understand why she was wavering.

The truth seemed to be just one step away.

But Xu Qingzhu was resisting.

Before seeing the person, she could speak confidently, but after seeing them, she suddenly became timid.

The string that had been taut in her heart suddenly snapped.

The beliefs she had always held onto collapsed with a roar. This was probably an extremely sorrowful thing.

Liang Shi let out a light breath. Seeing her drifting, unstable emotions, she suddenly understood why the system said when issuing the task that Xu Qingzhu might develop PTSD from learning about her biological parents.

Now she no longer had her usual composure, nor the confidence she'd shown when communicating with her on the way here.

All she had were slightly trembling legs and ice-cold hands.

Liang Shi squeezed her hand, mainly pressing on the area of her tiger's mouth¹, giving her a gentle massage, trying to help her relieve tension and anxiety.

"Then we won't go." Liang Shi said, "Let's go home. I'll come back tomorrow to get your bracelet for you."

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Let's go."

But her legs were weak, and she seemed unable to put strength into walking.

Liang Shi supported her, but after taking one step, Xu Qingzhu stopped again. She turned her body, and suddenly half of her body fell into the curtain of rain.

Then she gazed far off in the direction of that black umbrella.

Liang Shi supported her arm, saying gently, "Xu Qingzhu, let's go. Stop looking."

But Xu Qingzhu suddenly asked, "Do you think she still remembers that she once gave birth to a daughter?"

Liang Shi heard the slight crying tone in her voice, and her heart suddenly ached.

As if something had tugged at it.

Xu Qingzhu was so clever. She could easily connect all the clues together.

Even those few probing sentences Liang Shi had intentionally or unintentionally said.

It was just a kindergarten child mentioned a few days ago. This name was like so many ordinary names, nothing special about it.

But for Xu Qingzhu, she remembered it clearly.

Ling Dang said Sheng Yu's mother looked a lot like her.

Liang Shi had also tested her before the grave visit, whether she would go looking for her biological parents.

All the clues pointed in a very obvious direction.

Now Xu Qingzhu only needed to walk forward a few steps, go over and see that woman's face clearly, see what that little child looked like.

But her heart was pounding wildly.

People always seemed to be like this.

Reason and emotion pulled at each other to the extreme, forever wavering.

Liang Shi patted her shoulder, coaxing her like a little child. "Our Zhuzhu² has parents, so whether she remembers or not, what does it matter?"

Xu Qingzhu looked up at her, her eyes reddening.

She sniffled, her cool voice carrying a hint of complaint. "Teacher Liang, the wind is so strong here."

"Then I'll take you away." Liang Shi said.

As soon as her words fell, the mother and daughter pair had already stood up and were walking in their direction, holding their umbrella.

The wide umbrella brim obscured the woman's face. The exquisitely carved little child wore a mask, but those eyes were bright and lively, with the same eye shape as Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu only looked once. As they were about to approach, Xu Qingzhu instinctively tugged at Liang Shi's wrist, pressing the umbrella low. Rain from the umbrella's edge fell along the ribs onto the ground.

Drip, drip—

Xu Qingzhu directly stood on her tiptoes, taking advantage of the momentum to pull down Liang Shi's collar.

The distance between the two became extremely close. She closed her eyes, her breath falling on Liang Shi's face.

Xu Qingzhu's eyelashes kept trembling. The moment she closed her eyes, tears fell.

And her trembling lips landed lightly on Liang Shi's lips.

As if she had found all her support.

Footnotes

¹ *Tiger's mouth* - "虎口" (hǔkǒu) refers to the fleshy area between the thumb and index finger. In traditional Chinese medicine, this acupressure point is believed to help relieve stress, headaches, and anxiety when massaged.

² *Zhuzhu* - "竹子" (zhúzi) literally means "bamboo," but here it's being used as an affectionate nickname derived from Xu Qingzhu's name (清竹 contains the character 竹 meaning bamboo). Using "our Zhuzhu" (咱们竹子) shows Liang Shi speaking tenderly and protectively, like addressing a child or loved one.